

LISTENING

#03



ADVANCED

1 - Listen to a pilot's announcements during a flight. Answer the questions to understand the flight details, special instructions, and passenger information, then practice writing your own welcome message as the pilot.

Welcome Aboard: Flight Announcements

1 - Where is the flight headed?

2 - How long will the flight take?

3 - What is the weather forecast during the flight?

4 - What should you do if you have any special requests?

5 - At what time of day did the flight take place? (Morning, afternoon, or evening)

5 - What is the flight number?

6 - Writing Task:

Imagine you are the pilot of the airplane. Write a short introduction to welcome passengers aboard. (Choose your own airline company and include a greeting, destination, flight duration, and any important announcements.)

7 - What should you do if you need anything from the airline company during the flight?

Afraid of flying? Here are 7 tricks to manage your anxiety. By Rebecca Toy

Travelers typically welcome the jolt of excited adrenaline that sharpens the senses and takes our breath temporarily away—it's the physical proof of an awe-inspiring adventure. Yet, those same reactions, far less pleasant in the form of anxiety, are also an inevitable part of travel, the other side of novelty's biochemical coin.

For an increasing number of travelers, that anxiety is centered around flying. While air travel remains one of the [safest modes of transportation](#), an estimated [25 million adults in the United States experienced a degree of aerophobia](#) as of 2022. In the wake of tragic crashes in the first months of 2025, online searches for "fear of flying" and "flight anxiety" exponentially increased.

Yet travel demand remains up, with more than [5 billion airline passengers expected to fly](#) this year. For those experiencing increased flight anxiety, some for the first time, there are techniques that travelers can use to keep flying. Challenging intrusive thoughts is helpful, but the body's regulation is key.

"We feel like we have control of our minds and can reel them in, but we have a lot more control over our chemistry than we realize," explains Dr. Brian Ramos, a neuroscientist trained at the Yale School of Medicine and certified stress specialist. "We can flip a switch and bring awareness to our parasympathetic nervous system, rooting in the now and generating peace and calm."

Here's how to turn down distress by gaining control of the nervous system and why building resilient thoughts is best done—and first practiced—on the ground.

7 ways to calm your nerves if you have flight anxiety

1. Cool the body with chilled food and drinks—a cold canned beverage on the forehead often does the trick.

2. Gain control of the breath through slowing inhalation through the nose and exhalation through the mouth. [Many rhythms and strategies work](#); the key is to slow the breathing rate and focus on a pattern.

3. Use the senses to regulate with the "5-4-3-2-1" technique: Identify five things you can see, four you can touch, three you can hear, two you can smell, and one you can taste.

4. Pack sensory aids like sour candies, engaging textures, small, scented lotions, and download soothing audio tracks.

5. Embrace touch and have trusted travel companions apply gentle pressure, light caresses, or scalp massages with a soothing rhythm to maximize grounding benefits. Weighted blankets also create similar calming effects.

6. Create a mantra before flying that will help challenge intrusive thoughts.

7. Try counseling for persistent or severe symptoms and explore the roots of the fear.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

1 - What does Dr. Brian suggest travelers can do to gain control over their nervous system, and why does he emphasize practicing these techniques on the ground first?

2 - The author lists seven practical strategies to help manage flight anxiety. Describe at least three of these techniques and explain how each one helps reduce stress during a flight.